Silk Road Salts | Loyalty Intelligence

Review-Derived NPS for five specialty-salt competitors · Amazon US written reviews · analysis generated 2026-10-11

1. Competitive Loyalty Analysis

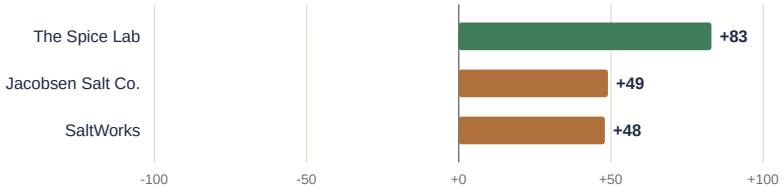
Rank	Competitor	Product (Amazon US)	n	Promoter	Passive	Detractor	NPS	95% CI
1	The Spice Lab	The Spice Lab Cyprus White Flake Kosher Salt, 8 oz bag ASIN B0030MZMIK	41	85.4%	12.2%	2.4%	**+83**	+70 to +96
2	Jacobsen Salt Co.	Jacobsen Salt Co. Pure Flake Sea Salt, 4 oz ASIN B01M32JS5F 5★ capped: NPS is a lower bound	175	70.3%	8.6%	21.1%	**+49**	+37 to +61
3	SaltWorks	SaltWorks Pacific Blue Sea Salt, Kosher Flake, 8 oz pour-spout pouch ASIN B077NRHK1F	40	70.0%	7.5%	22.5%	**+48**	+22 to +73
–	Maldon Salt	Maldon Salt, Sea Salt Flakes, 8.5 oz (240 g) ASIN B00017028M **Not ranked:** 5/4/3/1★ capped (see §3)	511	22.9%	23.3%	53.8%	**-31**	-38 to -24
–	Redmond Real Salt	Redmond Real Salt - Ancient Fine Sea Salt, Unrefined, 16 oz pouch ASIN B071FNYFWW **Not ranked:** 5/4/1★ capped (see §3)	497	22.5%	22.5%	54.9%	**-32**	-40 to -25

Four products are plain flake finishing salts; Redmond Real Salt sells no flake salt, so its fine-grain everyday salt is used. Its loyalty reflects a different use case (daily cooking salt) and package size, which limits direct comparison. Total analyzed written reviews: 1264. Source: Amazon US written reviews retrieved through Woot's public review endpoint (woot.com/review/Reviews/<ASIN>), using the open-source mrlong0129/amazon-review-scraper. Records are "source-retrieved", not independently matched to amazon.com permalinks.

Bucket boundaries

Promoter = 5★; Passive = 4★; Detractor = 1–3★. NPS = %Promoters − %Detractors, computed at full precision and rounded to a whole number. Five stars is the clearest written expression of enthusiasm; four-star reviews frequently carry reservations, mirroring the survey's 7–8 "passive" band; 1–3 stars signal dissatisfaction or materially qualified experience. These thresholds are judgment calls, so a sensitivity test follows. This is a **Review-Derived NPS**, not an official survey NPS.

Review-Derived NPS (baseline)



Not shown (retrieval cap set the star mix; NPS not comparable): Maldon Salt, Redmond Real Salt

2. Methodology, Sensitivity & Evidence

Alternative specification: 4–5★ = Promoter, 1–3★ = Detractor, no Passives

Competitor	Baseline NPS	Alternative NPS	Change (pts, exact)	4★ share	Rank: base → alt
The Spice Lab	+83	+95	+12.2	12.2%	1 → 1
Jacobsen Salt Co.	+49	+58	+8.6	8.6%	2 → 2
SaltWorks	+48	+55	+7.5	7.5%	3 → 3
Maldon Salt	-31	-8	+23.3	23.3%	– → –
Redmond Real Salt	-32	-10	+22.5	22.5%	– → –

Ranks are given only for comparable samples ("–" = not ranked, see section 1). The exact change always equals the 4★ share; displayed rounded values can differ by ±1 point due to rounding.

Three classified excerpts (verbatim, from stored records)

> **5★ Promoter** — Redmond Real Salt, 5★, 2026-10-07, id srs-0b78ec1e3ca4, source: Woot review endpoint (woot.com/review/Reviews/{ASIN}), Amazon US review data (product page)
> *"This is my favorite salt. I have bought it several times and am never disappointed."*

> **4★ Passive** — Redmond Real Salt, 4★, 2026-09-13, id srs-bd75c4a42fa2, source: Woot review endpoint (woot.com/review/Reviews/{ASIN}), Amazon US review data (product page)
> *"THIS SALT HAS A LOT OF MINERALS PLUS NO PLASTIC LIKE SEA SALT"*

> **1–3★ Detractor** — Redmond Real Salt, 3★, 2026-10-03, id srs-74cf58b2c8c4, source: Woot review endpoint (woot.com/review/Reviews/{ASIN}), Amazon US review data (product page)
> *"Came quickly. Smaller than expected and recently learned its been testing for significant levels of heavy metals. Pricier than other options anyway"*

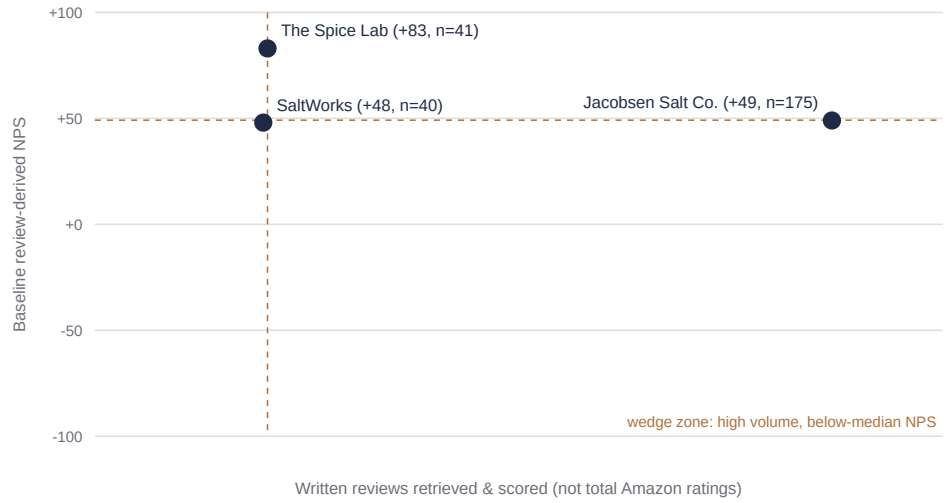
Selection bias

Online reviews overrepresent customers with unusually positive or negative experiences, creating a potentially bimodal distribution that exaggerates apparent customer polarization relative to the broader customer base.

- Review-derived NPS is not a survey of all purchasers; reviewers self-select (voluntary response bias).
- Possible fake or incentivized reviews (including Vine) are not removed; they are disclosed where flagged.
- The Woot endpoint returns at most 100 reviews per star-filter x sort combination (about 110-125 distinct reviews per star after combining four sort orders). Where several star buckets hit that cap, the retrieved star mix is set by the cap, not by customers, so that product's NPS is shown for transparency but is NOT ranked or used in the wedge. Where only the 5-star bucket is capped, the NPS is a lower bound. Per-product cap hits are listed in the tables; raw counts are in data/audits/collection_log.json.
- Written reviews only: star-only ratings (often the large majority of Amazon ratings) are not included.
- Product-level, not company-wide, loyalty: one SKU per brand.
- Review volume is not sales volume.
- Small differences in NPS (within the 95% intervals shown) should not be read as meaningful loyalty differences.
- Maldon Salt: 5/4/3/1-star bucket(s) hit the retrieval cap, so its NPS is not comparable and is not ranked.
- Jacobsen Salt Co.: 5-star bucket(s) hit the retrieval cap, so its NPS is a lower bound.
- Redmond Real Salt: 5/4/1-star bucket(s) hit the retrieval cap, so its NPS is not comparable and is not ranked.

3. Where Should Silk Road Salts Compete?

Loyalty vs. review volume



Not plotted (capped samples, NPS not comparable): Maldon Salt, Redmond Real Salt

X-axis: Distinct written reviews retrieved and scored (NOT total Amazon ratings; marketplace totals could not be retrieved).

1. Competitive overview

3 of 5 competitors have comparable scores. Baseline NPS ranges from +48 (SaltWorks, n=40) to +83 (The Spice Lab, n=41). Below the 50-review target: The Spice Lab (n=41); SaltWorks (n=40) (no comparable alternative ASIN found). Lower bound only (5★ bucket capped): Jacobsen Salt Co. (+49).

Not comparable: Maldon Salt (sample NPS -31, n=511; capped buckets: 5/4/3/1★); Redmond Real Salt (sample NPS -32, n=497; capped buckets: 5/4/1★). The endpoint returns at most ~110–125 distinct reviews per star bucket, so for these heavily reviewed products the retrieved star mix is set by the cap, not by customers. Their sample scores are an artifact of retrieval and say nothing about loyalty; they are excluded from ranks and from the wedge test.

2. Entry wedge

No high-volume / low-loyalty wedge can be shown from this data. Among the comparable products, none with at-or-above-median retrieved volume has below-median NPS. Maldon Salt, Redmond Real Salt could not be tested because of capped samples. The entry case therefore rests on the dissatisfaction themes below, not on a measured weak incumbent.

3. Customer dissatisfaction evidence → Silk Road response (hypothesis)

Keyword-rule coding of 595 retrieved detractor (1–3★) reviews. A review can match several themes; capped retrieval over-samples detractors of the most-reviewed products, so counts show what complaints say, not how common they are among buyers; rules are in pipeline/analyze.py and every match stores its review ID.

Theme	Detractor reviews	% of detractors	Competitors	Proposed response (untested)
Sourcing / authenticity / contaminants	144	24.2%	Maldon Salt (6), Redmond Real Salt (138)	Provenance documentation and third-party purity testing per lot.
Flavor / taste quality	104	17.5%	Maldon Salt (34), Jacobsen Salt Co. (4), SaltWorks (3), Redmond Real Salt (63)	Small-batch infusions using whole botanicals; tasting notes on pack.

Shipping damage / delivery	104	17.5%	Maldon Salt (99), Redmond Real Salt (5)	Protective secondary packaging for glass; ship-test before launch.

Representative complaint excerpts

- *“Came quickly. Smaller than expected and recently learned its been testing for significant levels of heavy metals. Pricier than other options anyway”* — 3★, Redmond Real Salt, id srs-74cf58b2c8c4 (Sourcing / authenticity / contaminants)
- *“I found this irritating! The flakes just bounce off a lot of the food I was salting. Nothing special to me about the taste!”* — 3★, Maldon Salt, id srs-743892039014 (Flavor / taste quality)

4. Positioning, target customer & validation (proposals, not evidence)

Target customer (assumption): home cooks who already buy premium finishing salt and gift food items.
Positioning (proposal): globally inspired, botanically infused finishing salts with documented provenance in resealable rigid packaging, addressing the measured complaint themes above. Prices and features are not yet tested.

1. **Smoke test:** landing page with 3 SKUs and a gift set; measure email sign-up rate from ~$200 of targeted ads.
2. **Packaging test:** mail 20 home cooks a pouch vs. a resealable tin; survey clumping/spillage after 4 weeks.
3. **Blind taste panel:** 15–20 participants compare an infused prototype vs. a leading competitor; ask a true NPS question.

Key uncertainties: retrieval caps, one SKU per brand, review volume ≠ sales, keyword coding misses sarcasm/negation, and no evidence yet that customers will pay a premium for infusion or provenance.